Natural Resources Committee Meeting
Beaufort County, SC

Council Chambers, Administration Building
Beaufort County Government Robert Smalls Complex
100 Ribaut Road, Beaufort

Monday, August 3, 2026
4:00 PM

MINUTES

Watch the video stream available on the County's website to hear the Council's discussion of a specific topic or the complete meeting **https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/395100**

1. Call to Order

Committee Chair Glover called the meeting to order at 4:18 PM

Present
Committee Chair York Glover
Committee Member Gerald Dawson - Virtual
Committee Vice-Chair Lawrence McElynn - Virtual
Committee Member Anna Maria Tabernik
Ex-Officio Alice Howard
Committee Member Passiment
Council Member David Bartholomew - @4:33 PM

Absent
Council Member Paula Brown
Council Member Logan Cunningham
Council Member Mark Lawson
Council Member Thomas Reitz

2. Pledge of Allegiance

Committee Chair Glover led the Pledge of Allegiance.

3. Statement of Compliance with FOIA

Committee Chair Glover stated that public notification of this meeting had been published, posted, and distributed in compliance with SC FOIA.

4. Approval of Agenda

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Tabernik to approve the agenda.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Glover, Committee Vice-Chair McElynn, Committee Member Dawson, Committee Member Tabernik, Ex-Officio Howard, and Committee Member Passiment. The motion passed 6:0.

5. Approval of Minutes

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Committee Member Tabernik to approve the minutes from May 4, 2026, and Special Called Meeting June 15, 2026.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Glover, Committee Vice-Chair McElynn, Committee Member Dawson, Committee Member Tabernik, Ex-Officio Howard, and Committee Member Passiment. The motion passed 6:0.

6. Public Comment Period

Public comments were taken. Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full comment period. **https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/395100**

7. Assistant County Administrator Report

Jared Fralix, Assistant County Administrator, gave an update on the status of the famous tree near the Pat Conroy Literacy Center. Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full report. **https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/395100**

8. Presentation and Discussion Items

a. Update on Green Space Program **(FISCAL IMPACT:)** - Michael McShane, Green Space Committee Chair

Michael McShane, Green Space Committee Chair, provided a Green Space program project update. Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full update. **https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/395100**

b. Discussion regarding Data Centers **(FISCAL IMPACT:)** -

The committee gave directions to staff to bring back options for consideration for data centers. Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full discussion. **https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/395100**

9. Agenda Items

a. 2026/33: An Ordinance Amending the Community Development Code (CDC): Division 5.10 (Historic Preservation), Section 7.2.120 (Certificate Of Appropriateness), Section 7.3.80 (Historic Designation), Section 7.4.50 (Public Hearing Scheduling and Notice), and Section 7.5.40 (Historic Preservation Review Board (Hprb)).

The vote at Natural Resources Committee on May 4, 2026 - 6:0
The vote at First Reading on May 26, 2026 - 9:1
The vote to defer Second Reading until the June 22, 2026 County Council meeting on June 8, 2026 - 11:0
The vote to remand back to Natural Resources committee on June 22, 2026 - 6:5 **(FISCAL IMPACT:)** - Robert Merchant, AICP, Beaufort County Planning and Zoning Department

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to deny the request for the text amendment for the following reasons: it is not consistent with the goals, objectives, and policies of the comprehensive plan; it is in conflict with any provision of this development code or the code of ordinances; it is not required by changed conditions; it does not address a demonstrated community need; it is not consistent with the purpose and intent of the zones in this development code, or would improve compatibility among uses and ensure efficient development within the county; it would not result in a logical and orderly development pattern; and it would result in adverse impacts on the natural environment including but not limited to water, air, noise, stormwater management, wildlife, vegetation, wetlands, and the natural functioning of the environment.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Member Dawson, Committee Member Tabernik, Committee Member Passiment, and Council Member Bartholomew

Voting Nay: Committee Chair Glover, Committee Vice-Chair McElynn, and Ex-Officio Howard. The motion passed 4:3.

b. An Ordinance amending the Community Development Code (CDC): section 5.3.20 (applicability), 4.2.20 (standards for free-standing accessory buildings/structures), 5.8.100 (screening), and 10.1.190 (definitions) **(FISCAL IMPACT: n/a)** - Robert Merchant

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Ex-Officio Howard to approve the request for the text amendment for the following reasons: it is consistent with the goals, objectives, and policies of the comprehensive plan; it is not in conflict with any provision of this development code or the code of ordinances; it is not required by changed conditions; it does address a demonstrated community need; it is consistent with the purpose and intent of the zones in this development code or would improve compatibility among uses and ensure efficient development within the county; it would result in a logical and orderly development pattern; and it would not result in adverse impacts on the natural environment including but not limited to water, air, noise, stormwater management, wildlife, vegetation, wetlands, and the natural functioning of the environment.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Glover, Committee Vice-Chair McElynn, Committee Member Dawson, Committee Member Tabernik, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, and Council Member Bartholomew. The motion passed 7:0.

c. An Ordinance amending the zoning map for 1.4 acres (r300 012 000 0129 0000, r300 012 000 047a 0000) from T2R to T2RC **(FISCAL IMPACT: n/a)** - Robert Merchant

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Ex-Officio Howard to approve the request for rezoning for the following reasons: it is consistent with the goals and policies of the comprehensive code and the purposes of the development code; it is not in conflict with provisions of the development code and our code of ordinances; it is not required by changed conditions; it is compatible with existing and proposed use of land surrounding this land; it would result in logical and orderly development patterns; it would not result in adverse impact on the natural environment, water, air, noise, stormwater management, wildlife, vegetation, wetlands, and the natural functioning of the environment; and it would result in development that is adequately served by public facilities, streets, potable water, sewer, stormwater management, solid waste collection and disposal, schools, parks, police, fire, emergency medical facilities.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Glover, Committee Vice-Chair McElynn, Committee Member Dawson, Committee Member Tabernik, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, and Council Member Bartholomew. The motion passed 7:0.

d. A Resolution authorizing the county administrator to execute a memorandum of agreement to engage in discussions about improvements and usage of the Battle of Port Royal Island site, subject to appropriate approval and securing of funding **(FISCAL IMPACT: Unknown)** - Monica Main, Deputy County Attorney; Stefanie Nagid, Director of Land Preservation; and Beaufort County 250th Commission

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to approve a Resolution authorizing the county administrator to execute a memorandum of agreement to engage in discussions about improvements and usage of the Battle of Port Royal Island site, subject to appropriate approval and securing of funding.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Glover, Committee Vice-Chair McElynn, Committee Member Dawson, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, and Council Member Bartholomew.

Voting Nay: Committee Member Tabernik. The motion passed 6:1.

e. Approval and authorization for the county administrator to enter into an agreement for a public-private partnership with Brickyard Commons, LLC for a Royal Pines drainage project. **(FISCAL IMPACT: The total cost of the project is $3,475,000 that would be paid from Stormwater Utility 5025-90-9020-54420 with a balance of $6,275,000.00)** - Jared Fralix, Assistant County Administrator, 10 minutes

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to approve the approval and authorization for the county administrator to enter into an agreement for a public-private partnership with Brickyard Commons, LLC for a Royal Pines drainage project.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Glover, Committee Vice-Chair McElynn, Committee Member Dawson, Committee Member Tabernik, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, and Council Member Bartholomew. The motion passed 7:0.

10. Adjournment

Ratified: September 8, 2026